Crochet Studio: Tester Guide

Welcome

Thanks for testing Crochet Studio! It's an app for crochet makers to track products, materials, pricing, patterns, markets and sales, all in one place.

This is an **early test version**. Some things may be unfinished or a little buggy, and that's exactly what your feedback helps fix. Install takes about a minute, and there's a short list of questions at the end.

"Crochet Studio" is just a working name. The app will get its final name before it launches in the app stores. Your account and data will carry over.

Install the app

The app link is [crochetstudiotest.netlify.app](). Open it on your phone or tablet, then follow the steps for your device. It works on phones and tablets, and without internet once installed.

Android (use Chrome)

1. Open **Chrome** and go to crochetstudiotest.netlify.app.
2. Tap the ⋮ menu (top right) and choose **Install app** or **Add to Home screen**.
3. Tap **Install**. Crochet Studio appears on your home screen like any other app.

iPhone and iPad (use Safari)

1. Open **Safari** and go to crochetstudiotest.netlify.app. It has to be Safari: other browsers on iPhone can't add apps to the home screen.
2. Tap the **Share** button (the square with an arrow pointing up).
3. Scroll down, tap **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**.

After that, always open Crochet Studio from its home-screen icon, not the browser.

Updates: when a new version is ready, a "New version ready" bubble appears. Tap **Refresh** and you're up to date.

Why the link ends in "netlify.app"

The address is safe: Netlify is just the company that hosts the app while it's being tested.

- **Netlify** is a well-known web hosting service used by millions of websites, a bit like renting a storefront. Every site hosted there gets an address ending in **.netlify.app**.
- "crochetstudiotest" is the name chosen for this test version. The app will move to its own address, and later to the app stores, closer to launch.
- The link uses **https** (the padlock in your browser), so everything sent between your phone and the app is encrypted.
- The app never asks for payment details or your bank information.

If your phone says "unsafe app"

Some Android phones show a warning like **"unsafe app"** or **"built for an older version of Android"** when you install. It's expected for apps that aren't from the Play Store yet, and doesn't mean anything is wrong.

- **Why it happens:** Android's built-in checker (Google Play Protect) warns about any app that didn't come from the Play Store. Crochet Studio isn't in the Play Store yet because it's still in testing.
- **What the app can access:** it's a web app, so it can only use what you allow, like choosing a photo or file. It can't see your contacts, messages or other apps.
- **What to do:** tap **Install anyway** (sometimes under **More details**).
- **Prefer to skip the warning?** In Chrome, use ⋮ → **Add to Home screen** → **Create shortcut** instead. It works the same way.

iPhones and iPads don't show this warning.

Accounts and your data

You can use the app with or without an account. An account keeps your data safe in the cloud and lets you use it on more than one device.

Creating an account

1. On the Welcome screen, tap **Sign up with email**, enter your email and a password, and tap **Create account**.
2. Open the email from Crochet Studio (it may come from "Supabase") and tap **Confirm your mail**. Check spam or promotions if you don't see it within a few minutes.
3. A page says "Email confirmed". Go back to the app and tap **Continue**.

4. Enter your name. If you already used the app, tap **Yes, move it** to put your existing data into your account.

To use the app on another phone or tablet, install it there and tap **Sign in**. Everything appears, including photos and pattern files.

Without an account

Tap **Continue without an account** and everything stays on that device only. You can sign up later in **Settings → Account**. Without an account, use **Settings → Backup & restore** now and then, since a lost phone means lost data.

How your data is kept safe

- **Private to you:** your account's data is stored with **Supabase**, a secure cloud database service. Security rules make sure only you can read your products, sales, photos and patterns. Other testers can't see them, and the app owner doesn't browse them.
- **Encrypted:** everything sent between your phone and the cloud is encrypted (https).
- **Saved on your phone first:** the app works with no signal, for example at markets, and syncs when you're back online.
- **Your choice: Settings → Account → Sign out** removes the data from that device (it stays in your account). **Delete account** permanently deletes your account and everything in it.
- **Patterns:** only import patterns you have permission to use. They're stored privately and are never shared. While testing, each account can keep up to 5 patterns.

Card payments with Square (optional)

If you take cards with Square, Crochet Studio can open the Square app with the sale total already entered. The money goes to your own Square account, and Square's normal card fees apply.

One-time setup

1. Install **Square Point of Sale** (by Block, Inc.) from the Play Store or App Store. Sign in to your Square account and choose your location. Connect your card reader in Square if you use one.
2. In Crochet Studio, check **Settings → Country & currency** (Canada · CAD or United States · USD). Square charges in this currency, so it must match your Square account's country.

3. In Crochet Studio, go to **Settings → Payments** and turn on **Use Square for card payments**.
4. If Crochet Studio adds tax to your sales (Settings → Tax), turn off Square's own sales tax so tax isn't charged twice.
5. Tap **Test Square with $1.00**, take the payment in Square, then refund the $1 in the Square app.

Taking a card payment

1. Add the items to the sale (from a market, or with **Quick sale**) and tap **Review sale**.
2. Choose **Card** and tap **Charge with Square**. Square opens with the total ready.
3. Take the payment in Square. When it's done, Square sends you back and the sale is saved.

Good to know

- **Square needs its app on this device.** Crochet Studio hands the sale to the **Square Point of Sale** app on the same phone or tablet. Being signed in to Square in a web browser doesn't work.
- **"Invalid request" from Square** usually means your country & currency doesn't match your Square account, or the Square app needs updating (Play Store or App Store). Fix that, then tap Card again.
- **On Android, Square may send you back to your web browser** instead of the Crochet Studio app. This happens because the test version is a web app: Square can only send you back using a web link, and Android opens web links in your browser. Once Crochet Studio is in the Play Store and App Store, Square will return straight to the app. For now, the browser page saves the sale and tells you to close it. Close that tab and go back to Crochet Studio; the sale will be there.
- **If Square doesn't send you back at all**, go back to Crochet Studio yourself. It will ask "Did the Square payment go through?" Answer Yes or No.
- **If you cancel in Square**, the sale stays open so you can try again or choose cash.
- **Refunds are done in Square.** Deleting or changing a card sale in Crochet Studio doesn't refund the customer.

Bring in your spreadsheet (beta)

If you use the CrochetWBay pricing spreadsheet, the app can bring in your yarn and eye price lists, your hourly wage and your products, so you don't have to type them all again.

1. If your spreadsheet is in Google Sheets, open it and choose **File → Download → Microsoft Excel (.xlsx)**.
2. In Crochet Studio, go to **Settings → Import from spreadsheet** and tap **Choose spreadsheet file**.
3. Check the summary: how many products and materials were found, and any rows that were skipped and why. Tap **Add**.
4. Open a few products and check their materials, prices and stock, then add photos.

Good to know

- **Google Sheets users: download the file first.** Opening your sheet in the browser isn't enough, because the app needs a copy saved on your phone or computer. In Google Sheets choose **File → Download → Microsoft Excel (.xlsx)**, then pick that downloaded file in the app.
- Nothing is added until you tap **Add**. Products already in the app (same name) are left as they are.
- Yarn costs include the shipping per ball from your sheet. Each product gets 1 pair of eyes, like the spreadsheet.
- **Yarn colours aren't in the spreadsheet**, since it's built for pricing. Each yarn comes in as one type with its price and ball weight, and one variation labelled **No variation set** (for example, Chenille Home Heather, 1 variation). To track colours, open the yarn in Materials and add each colour as a variation.
- **Eyes are grouped by type, with the size as the variation.** For example, 10mm and 12mm glitter eyes become one type, Glitter eyes, with sizes 10 mm and 12 mm. Eyes with no size in the name (like Felt) stay as their own type.
- **Spreadsheets don't have photos.** Tap any empty photo square (on a product, or in Materials) to take or choose one.
- Something look wrong? **Undo this import** (on the last screen, or later in Settings → Import from spreadsheet) removes only what was added.
- This feature is brand new, so please tell us if anything came in wrong.

What to try

Use the app as you normally would for your business. If you can, try each of these at least once:

- [ ] Add a few **materials** (yarn, eyes, stuffing) with prices and where you bought them

- [ ] Create a **product**, add its materials and time to make, and check the **suggested price**
- [ ] If you have the CrochetWBay spreadsheet, **import it** (Settings → Import from spreadsheet) and check what came in
- [ ] Add product **photos** and give products **tags** (a product can have more than one)
- [ ] Import a **pattern** (PDF or photo, up to 5 while testing) and open it
- [ ] Plan a **market**: dates, booth cost, packing list and to-do list
- [ ] Record **sales** at a market, then mark the market **completed**
- [ ] Look at **Reports** for different time frames
- [ ] Change **Settings** (pricing defaults, tax, include tax in material costs)
- [ ] Use the app with **no internet** (airplane mode), then turn it back on
- [ ] With an account: **sign in on a second device** and check everything came across
- [ ] If you use Square: run the $1 test, then take a real card sale through Crochet Studio
- [ ] Make a **backup** (Settings → Backup & restore)

Feedback questions

After a week or two of use, please answer these. Short answers are perfect.

About you

1. What phone or tablet do you use (for example Samsung Galaxy S23, iPhone 14, iPad)?
2. Do you sell at markets, online, or both? Roughly how many markets a year?
3. What do you use now to track inventory, costs and sales (notebook, spreadsheet, another app, nothing)?

Using the app

4. Was installing and creating an account easy? Where did you get stuck, if anywhere?
5. Which features did you use most?
6. Was anything confusing, or did anything not work the way you expected?
7. Did the suggested prices seem right for your work? Too high or too low?
8. Did anything look wrong on your screen (text cut off, buttons hard to tap)?
9. Did anything break, freeze or lose your data?

Looking ahead

10. What's missing that would make you use this every day?

11. Down the road, some features (like cloud sync and photo/pattern storage) may be part of a paid plan. **Which of these would you pay for?** Pick all that seem fair to you:
    - Free only. I wouldn't pay for it
    - $2 a month
    - $3 a month
    - $5 a month
    - $20 a year (about $1.67 a month)
    - $30 a year (about $2.50 a month)
    - $50 a year (about $4.17 a month)
12. Would you rather pay **monthly** or **once a year** (at a lower overall price)?
13. Which features should always be **free**, and which would you be happy to have in a paid plan?
14. On a scale of 1 to 10, how likely are you to recommend it to another maker? Why?

Reporting problems and good to know

The easiest way to send feedback is **Settings → Send feedback**. It opens an email to us with your app version and device already filled in. Use it for problems, ideas and anything confusing.

The app version and device details are shown on screen before the email opens, and nothing is sent until you tap send in your email app. You can delete or change anything in the email first.

When something goes wrong, send a message with:

- a **screenshot** of the screen
- what you tapped just before it happened
- your phone or tablet model

Known limits of the test version

- **Google and Apple sign-in** show "Soon". Use email for now.
- **Confirmation emails can be slow** and may land in spam. If several people sign up at once, the email may take a while. Wait a few minutes before tapping "Send a new email".
- **Syncing between devices** happens within a few minutes, not instantly. Tap **Sync now** in Settings → Account if you're in a hurry.

- **Patterns are limited to 5 per account** while testing, to keep storage free. Delete one to add another.
- **Spreadsheet import is in beta.** Always check imported products, and use Undo if something looks off.
- If you change the same thing on two devices while both are offline, the **most recent change wins**.
- The test version is **free**. Paid features and subscriptions come later, and you'll be told well before anything changes.

Tips

- Open the app from the home-screen icon, not the browser. Data in the browser and the installed app can be separate on iPhone.
- **Include tax in material costs** (Settings → Tax) is on, so costs and suggested prices use what you actually paid for supplies. Turn it off if you're registered for HST and claim the tax back.
- If a small **Powered by Netlify** badge appears in the bottom-right corner, tap it and choose **Hide**. It comes from the hosting service, not the app.
- Tap **Refresh** whenever "New version ready" appears.
- Delete your account any time in **Settings → Account → Delete account**.